

GAMBIA DIAGNOSTIC

HIGH-LEVEL ASSESSMENT OF IDENTITY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM



 **ID4D** Identification
For Development

 **THE WORLD BANK**
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OUTLINE

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- 1 Context and Introduction
 - 2 Overview of Legal and Institutional Framework
 - 3 Overview of National ID and CRVS Systems
 - 4 Core Foundational and Functional Systems
 - 5 Sectoral Systems and Relationship with ID Systems
 - 6 Summary of Challenges and Recommendations
 - 7 Case Studies of Other Countries
 - 8 Next Steps
-

About ID4D

The World Bank Group's Identification for Development (ID4D) Initiative uses global knowledge and expertise across sectors to help countries realize the transformational potential of digital identification (ID) systems to achieve the Sustainable Development Goals. It operates across the World Bank Group with units working on digital transformation, social protection, health, financial inclusion, agriculture, governance, gender, legal, and research, among others. The mission of ID4D is to enable all people to access services and exercise their rights, by improving the inclusivity, design, and governance of ID and civil registration (CR) systems. ID4D makes this happen through its three pillars of work: (1) thought leadership and analytics to fill knowledge gaps; (2) global convening and networks to amplify good practices; and (3) country and regional action to support the implementation of trusted, inclusive, and responsible ID and CR systems. The work of ID4D is made possible with support from the World Bank Group, Gates Foundation, UK Government, French Government, Norwegian Agency for Development Cooperation, and Omidyar Network. To find out more, visit id4d.worldbank.org.

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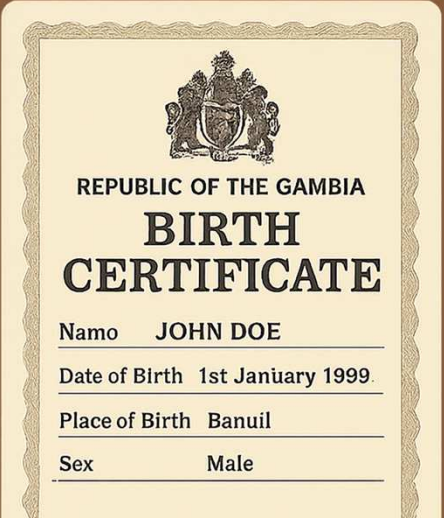
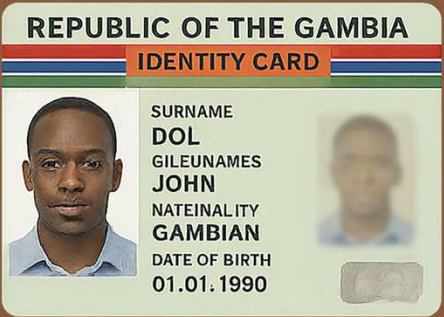
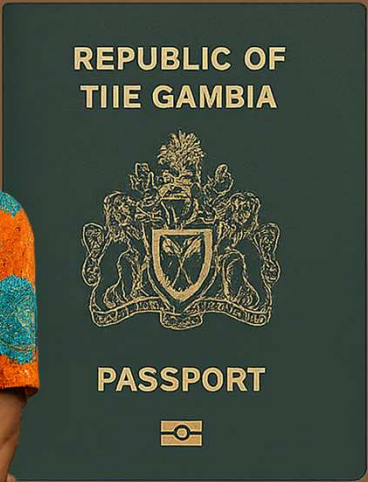
The team is also grateful to the Digital Transformation for Africa/ Western Africa Regional Digital Integration Program Project's Implementation Unit, particularly project coordinator Serign Omar Lowe, for their support.

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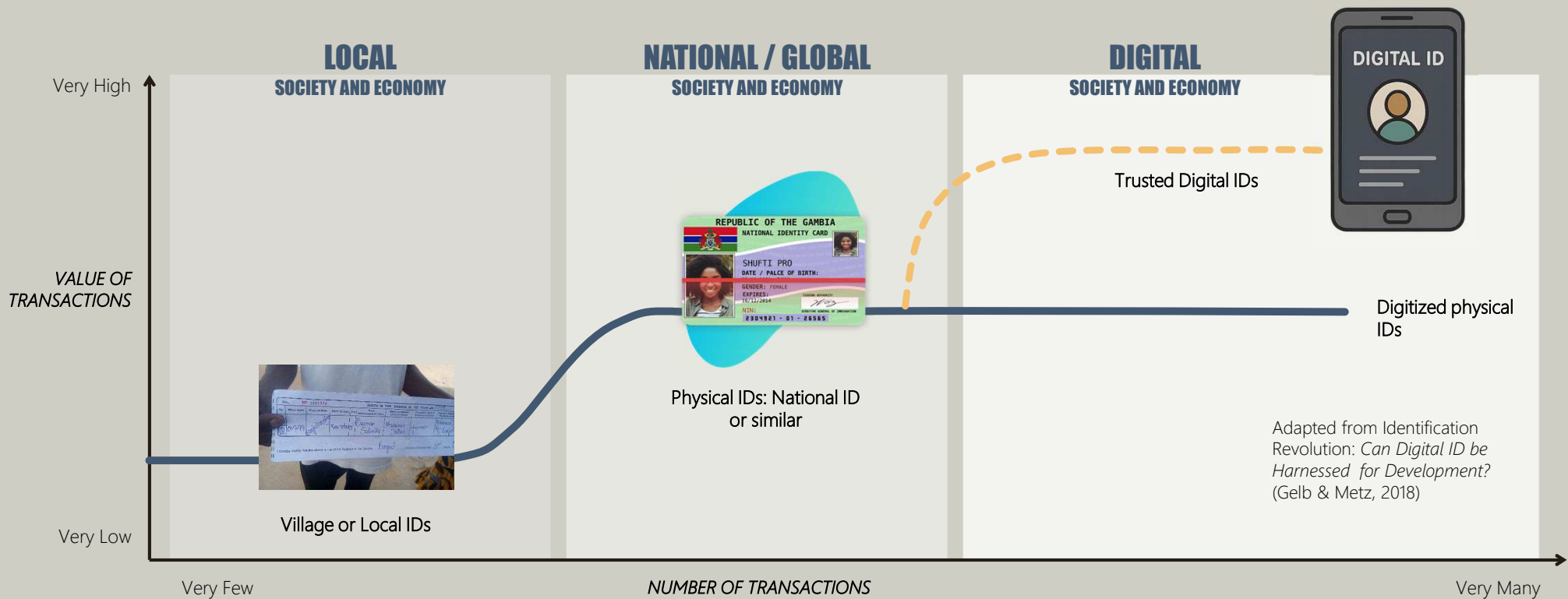
CONTEXT AND INTRODUCTION

Historically, trust and identity were established through familiarity.

... and then taking physical / legal IDs on face value



FROM LEGAL ID TO DIGITAL ID



A Digital ID is virtual representation of a Legal ID – a secure online identity that enables seamless verification and access to essential services, driving economic growth, social and financial inclusion.

TYPES OF ID SYSTEMS

ID systems collect and validate identity attributes and issue credentials (numbers, cards, mobile IDs, etc.) as proof of this identity.

“FOUNDATIONAL”

General or multi-purpose:

National ID

Civil register

Population register

etc.

VS

“FUNCTIONAL”

Sectoral or specific-purpose:

Electoral register

Social register or number

Driver’s license

Tax ID number



DIGITAL

if it uses digital technology throughout the identity lifecycle



UNIQUE

If each identity corresponds to one person, and each person only has one identity in the system



UNIVERSAL

if it covers the entire population

ID OWNERSHIP IS STRONGLY ASSOCIATED WITH ACCESS TO SERVICES AND OPPORTUNITIES

CHILDREN WITH BIRTH CERTIFICATES ARE MORE LIKELY TO ...



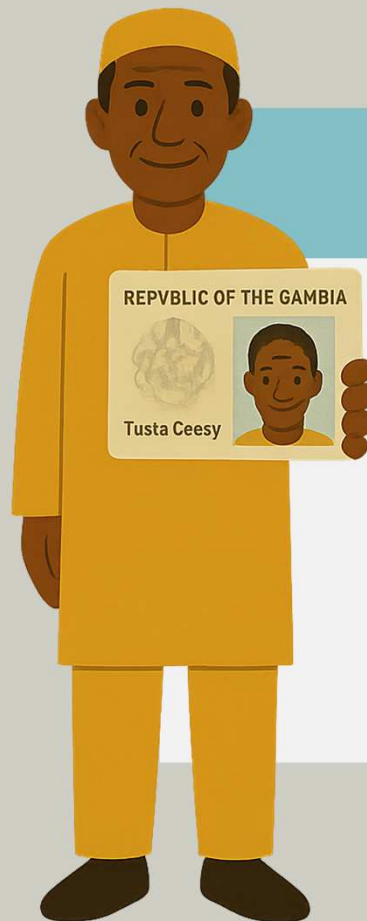
Attend school, be in age-appropriate classes, spend longer in school, and graduate



Have vaccinations, higher birthweights, and receive proper diarrheal treatment

Sources: Apland et al. (2014), Brito et al. (2013), Corbacho et al. (2012), Oppenheim & Powell (2015)

ADULTS WITH ID ARE MORE LIKELY TO ...



Own a bank account and mobile phone



Have access to credit and own property, and be employed in the formal sector



Have health insurance and access social services



For women, vote in elections

Sources: Castro & Rud (2011), Cheema et al. (2016), Caribou (2020), Metz & Clark (2019); MSC (2019)

DIGITAL ID IN SERVICE OF NATIONAL DEVELOPMENT & DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

ACCESS TO HEALTH

Increased access to health/universal coverage requires countries to identify beneficiaries. More accurate vital statistics tracks health targets



INDONESIA

increased birth certification rates closely correlated with reduced child marriage

GENDER EQUALITY & INCLUSION

Women struggle to assert their rights and access services without ID



PAKISTAN

digital ID system provided direct access of cash transfers to women for the first time. Evaluations showed that, as a result, households spent more on nutrition and child education, and increased women's household decision making.

SOCIAL SAFETY NETS & REFUGEES

870 m people living in extreme poverty don't have access to social assistance programs. ID enables efficient targeting and cost-effective and secure digital transfers



PAKISTAN

flood relief using the national ID database to make payments to 2.94 million families in 2010 – Registered 1.7 million Afghan Refugees and provided assistance

IMPROVED GOVERNANCE

Authentication based on national ID makes governments more accountable and transparent. Risks of leakages and fraud can be minimized.



ARGENTINA

linking 13 public databases and distinct ID registries, allowed to save US\$104 million, through reduced leakages and tax evasion

FINANCIAL INCLUSION

Approx 375 million unbanked adults in developing countries (18%) are constrained by not having the necessary ID documentation



INDIA

the Reserve Bank of India approved the use of the Aadhaar ID as a proof of identity to meet the regulatory KYC requirements. There are now approximately 170 million bank accounts open.

INTRODUCTION

This presentation summarizes the initial steps taken towards assessing the foundational ID system(s) in The Gambia to determine if these systems are robust, trusted, inclusive and can be used to help achieve of development goals (SDGs), improve service delivery and support private sector to grow digital economy.

IMPORTANCE OF ROBUST ID SYSTEMS

A reliable and secure ID system has

- Low error rates in enrollment and authentication.
- High citizen satisfaction and adoption rates.
- Minimal incidence of fraud or misuse
- Effective coordination across sectors and stakeholders (functional repositories)

GAMBIAN CONTEXT ID SYSTEM– KEY SUMMARY

Complexity of the Gambian ID landscape involves:

- Low Coverage (No Universal coverage of National ID)
- Fragmented Institutional Mandates
- Disparate databases and interoperability challenges.
- Need online identity authentication mechanism and eKYC
- Ongoing developments and potential integration plans

10 PRINCIPLES

INCLUSION

DESIGN

GOVERNANCE

1

Ensure universal access for individuals, free from discrimination

2

Remove barriers to access and use

3

Establish a trusted—unique, secure, and accurate—identity

4

Create a responsive and interoperable platform

5

Use open standards and prevent vendor and technology lock-in

6

Protect privacy and agency through system design.

7

Plan for financial and operational sustainability

8

Protect personal data, maintain cyber security, and safeguard people's rights through a comprehensive legal and regulatory framework

9

Establish clear institutional mandates and accountability

10

Enforce legal and trust frameworks through independent oversight and adjudication of grievances

GAMBIA –DIGITAL SNAPSHOT



- Population: **2.42 Million**
- Aged 18+: **1.39M**



- Male: **49.8 %**



- Female: **50.2%**



- Social Media Users: **449K**
- **16.1%** of population



- Cell Phones: **3.15M**
- **113%** of population



- ID Card Holders: 831,747 against 1.39M -**Adult Coverage: 60%**
- ID Registration with Biometrics: **831,747**
- Birth Registration: **1.2 M Coverage: 50%**



- Internet Penetration: **45.9%**
- **1.28M Users**



- Immigration Dept. Offices for National ID Registration
- **6 fixed**
 - **12 mobile**



- Population Spread
- Urban: 963,800 -**35.5%**
 - Rural: 1.75 million -**64.5%**

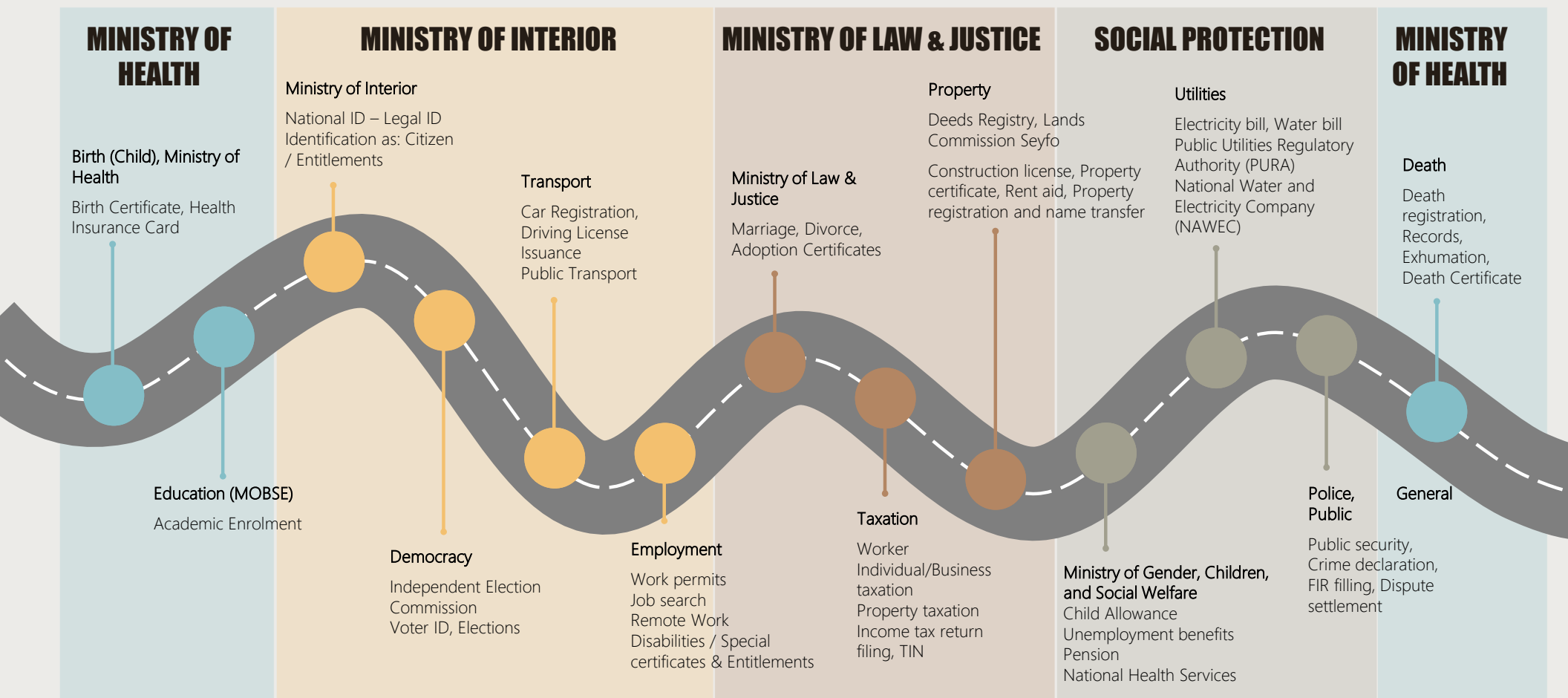


- The Gambia is divided into **43 districts** under **8 Local Government Areas**

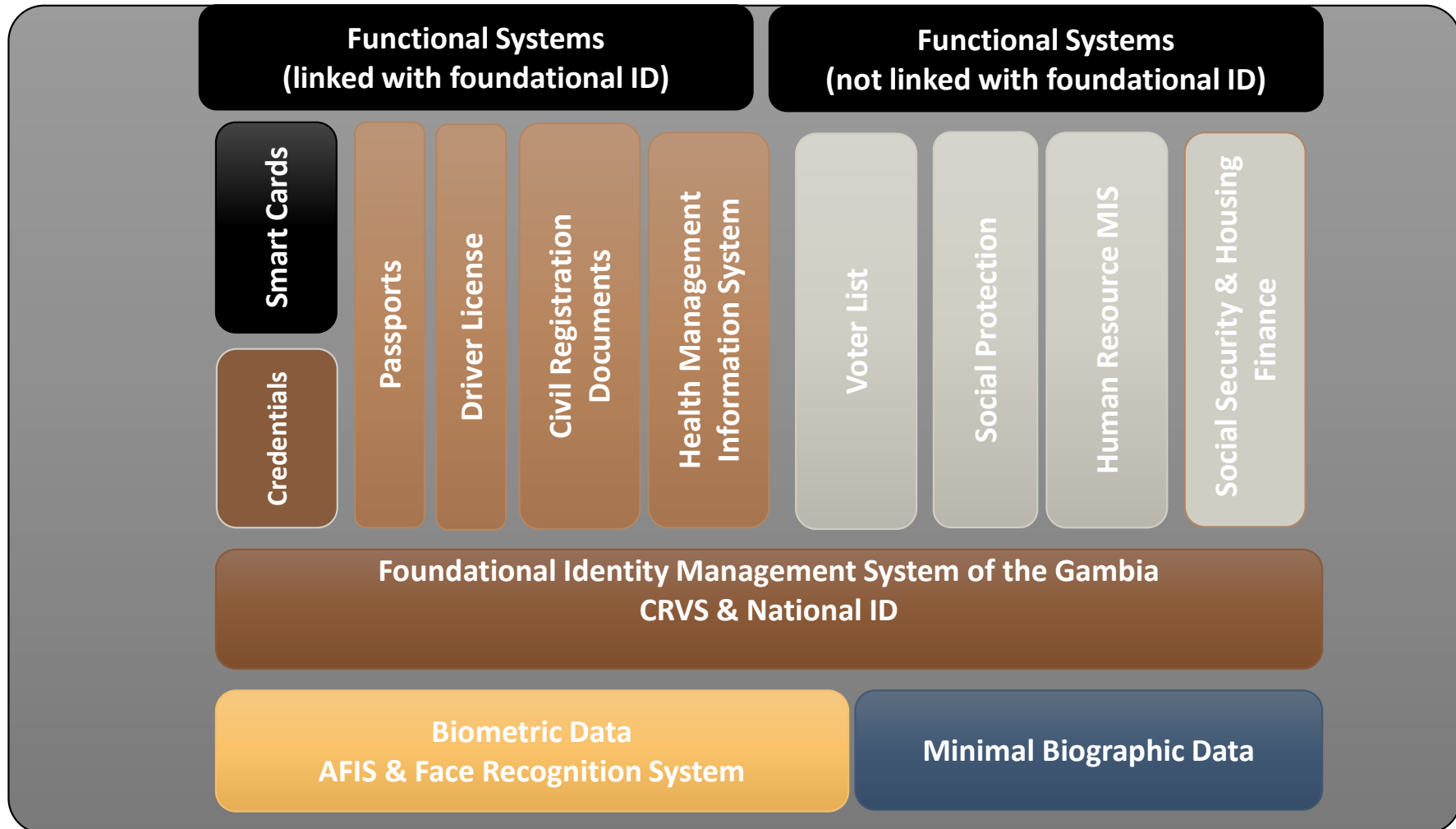
JOURNEY OF IDS

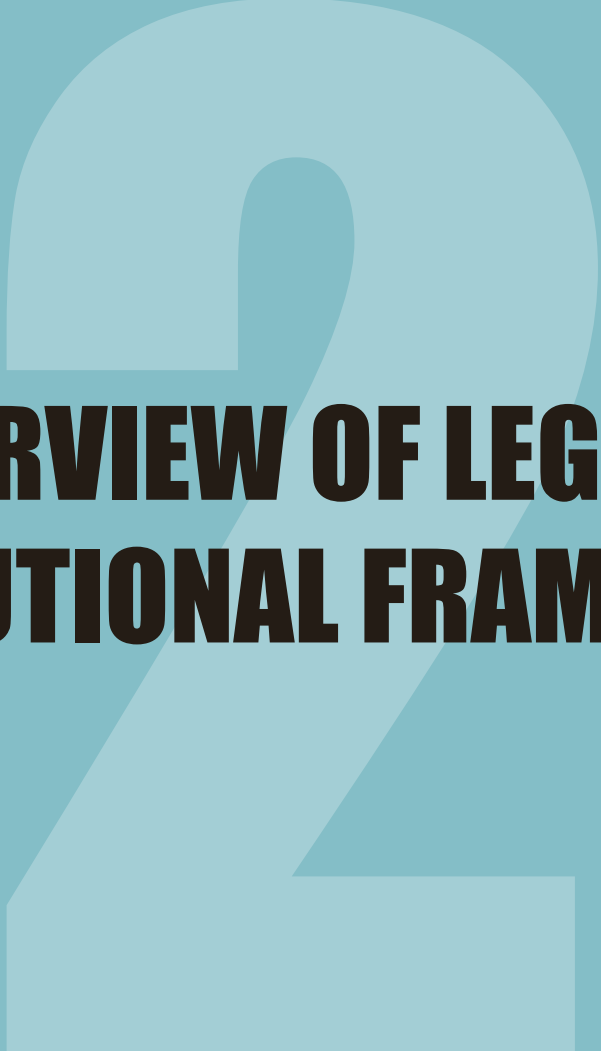
Ministry of Communications and Digital Economy (MOCDE)

Gambia Information and Communication Technology Authority.(GICTA) Digitalization of Journey, DPI



FOUNDATIONAL & FUNCTIONAL ID SYSTEM –HIGH-LEVEL OVERVIEW





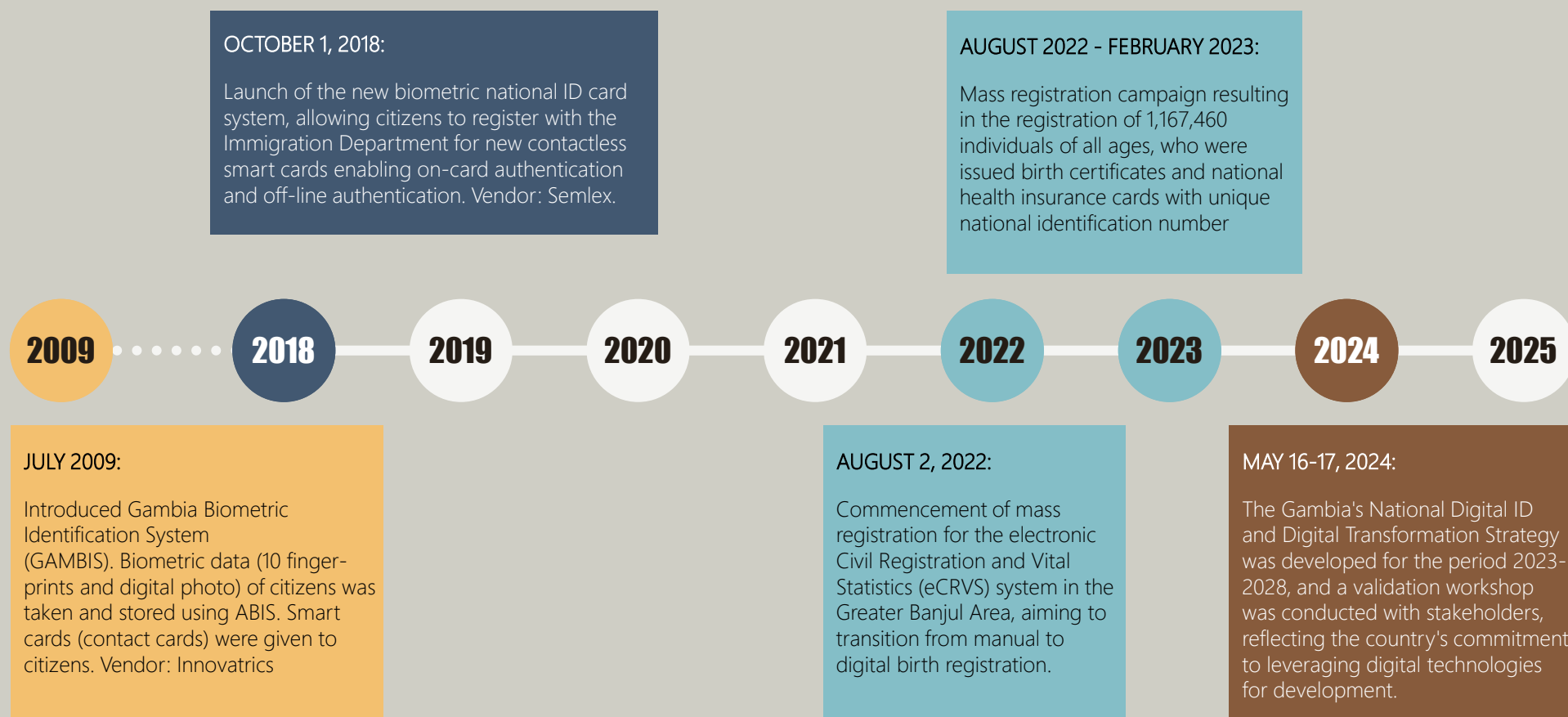
OVERVIEW OF LEGAL & INSTITUTIONAL FRAMEWORK

OVERVIEW OF LEGAL & INSTITUTIONAL MANDATE

MINISTRY OF COMMUNICATIONS AND DIGITAL ECONOMY (MOCDE)	MINISTRY OF INTERIOR	MINISTRY OF HEALTH	MINISTRY OF LAW & JUSTICE	INDEPENDENT ELECTION COMMISSION
Head: Permanent Secretary Mandate: To promote the efficiency and international competitiveness of The Gambia in ICT sector Head: DG GICTA Mandate: Pivot digitalization agenda by leading and coordinating the implementation of ICT activities and programs across the government. This includes initiatives such as e-Government services, the development of a national data center, and the issuance of digital IDs	Head: DG Department of Immigration Mandate: Issuing authority of National IDs, Passports, Work Permits, Visas and border management Head: Inspector General of Police Mandate: Issuing authority of Drivers License	Head: Registrar General of Births & Deaths Mandate: Issuing Authority of Birth and Death Certificates and Health Insurance Cards	Head: Registrar General of Marriages, Divorces and Adaption Mandate: Issuing authority of Marriages, Divorces and Adoption Certificates	Head: Chairman Mandate: Preparation of Voters List, Issuing authority of Voters ID, and conduct of elections

- **FRAGMENTATION:** Different ministries issue identity-related documents, some different vendor-dependent
- **LACK OF INTEROPERABILITY:** No unified system connecting all identity documents.
- **NEED FOR INTEGRATION:** Digital ID can unify all legal identity documents under a single framework.

TIMELINE –KEY INITIATIVES TO MODERNIZE IN THE GAMBIA'S NATIONAL ID & CRVS



ASSESSMENT OF LEGAL FRAMEWORK

1

GAPS IN INCLUSION

National ID exclusion – A significant portion of **adults do not have ID card**(~39% gap). Not all residents can access the Digital ID system

No legal provisions addressing the status of Refugees & Stateless Individuals

2

GAPS IN DATA PROTECTION & PRIVACY

No comprehensive data protection framework exists. Current references are limited:

- Constitutional right to privacy (undefined scope).
- Children's Act 2005 (vague child privacy rights).
- Sector-specific rules (e.g., Communications Act) but insufficient.

Pending solution: Data Protection & Privacy Bill (2023) – if enacted, will fill critical gaps.

3

GAPS IN CYBERSECURITY

No legal framework for identifying/mitigating cyber threats.

No dedicated institutions (e.g., cybersecurity response units). However, there are some plans in progress:

- National Cybersecurity Strategy (2022–2026).
- Draft Communications Bill (2023) proposes cyber units.

Cybercrime laws exist but lack enforcement mechanisms. Cybercrime Response Unit is coming up

ASSESSMENT OF LEGAL FRAMEWORK

4

GAPS IN INTERNATIONAL DATA FLOWS & ID RECOGNITION

No restrictions on cross-border personal data transfers. DP Bill (2023) would regulate this but not yet enacted.

No mutual recognition of foreign IDs or interoperability agreements.

5

GAPS IN GOVERNANCE & INDIVIDUAL RIGHTS

No statutory rights for individuals over their data.

- DP Bill introduces rights (e.g., access, deletion) but excludes data portability.

No data protection authority:

- DP Bill proposes an Information Commission (ADI) with oversight powers.

6

GAPS IN NATIONAL ID CARD FRAMEWORK

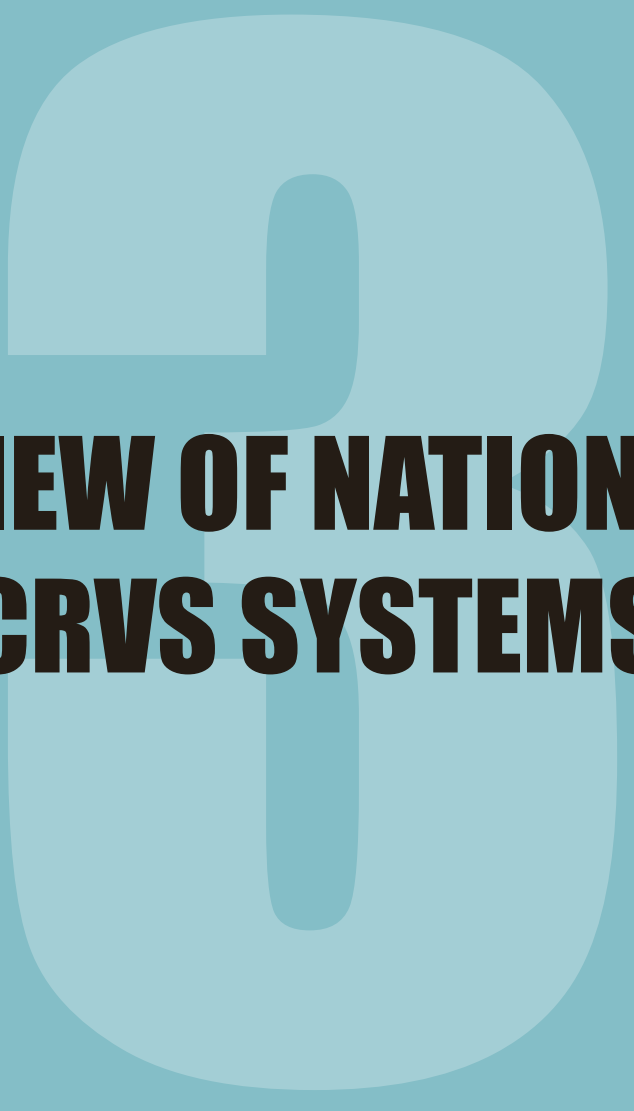
Design: No requirements for open standards/vendor neutrality (risk of "lock-in").

Data Protection: No rules on storage, use, or security of ID system data.

Governance: Missing provisions on:

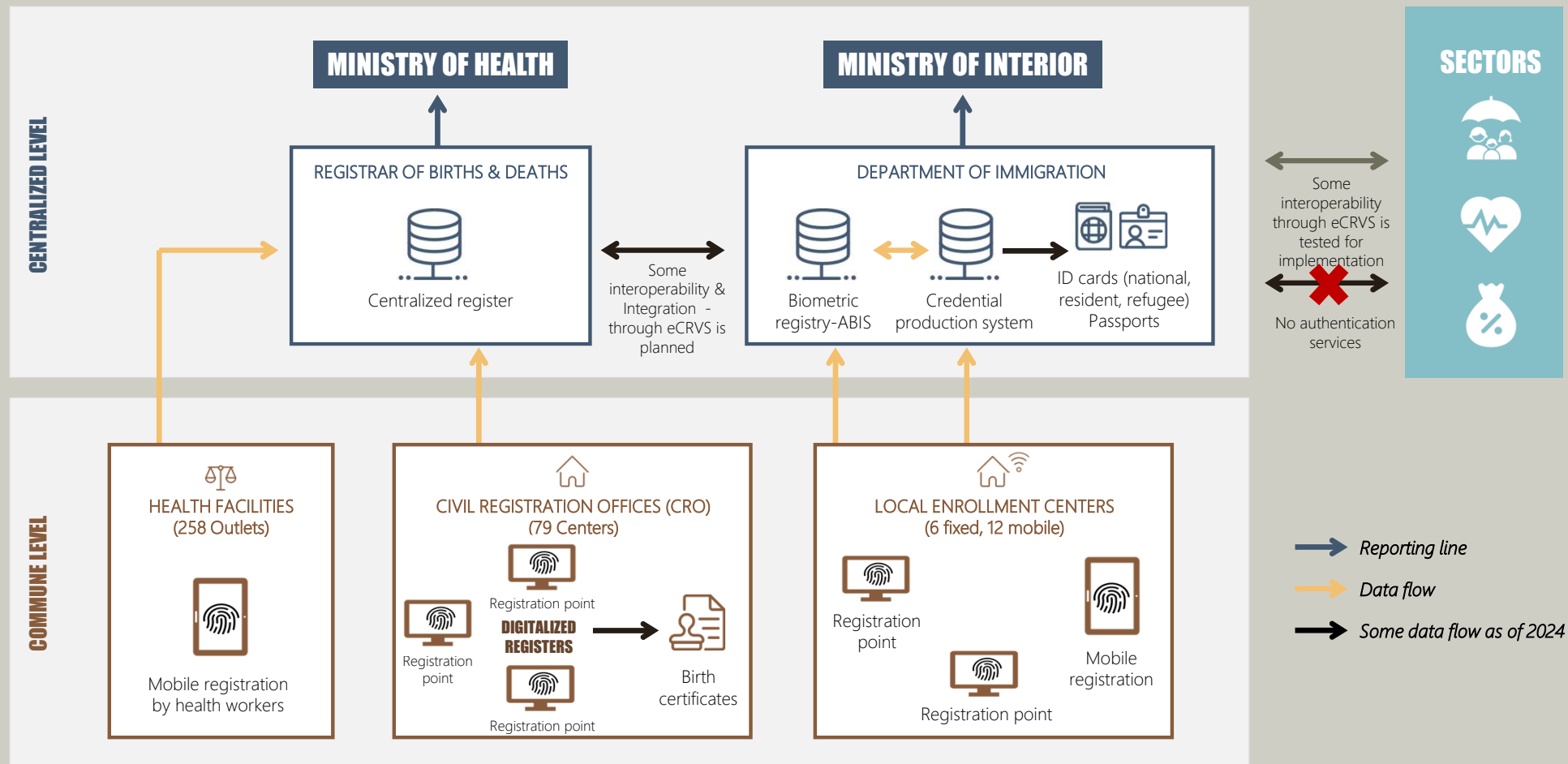
- Informed consent procedures.
- Data access, correction, deletion rights.

Redress Mechanisms: No legal pathways for complaints/privacy violations.



OVERVIEW OF NATIONAL ID & CRVS SYSTEMS

OVERVIEW OF NATIONAL ID & CRVS SYSTEM



WORLD BANK SUPPORT

Deployment of eCRVS system

-Lending Operation P173287 – Ending in August, 2025

Integration of eCRVS system (HERA software) and electronic ID (eID) system

-Lending Operation P173287 – Ending in August, 2025

Development of interoperability documents and interoperability effected for eCRVS system with electronic Human Resource Management Information System (eHRMIS) and electronic National Health Insurance System (eNHIS)

Financial support for satellite internet connectivity

Lending Operation - WARDIP -Ongoing

User acceptance testing (UAT) for an integrated eCRVS/eID to produce health insurance cards (for Gambians and non-Gambians) completed in April 2025. UAT for driver's license and ID cards will be done in May 2025 -Lending Operation P173287 – Ending in August, 2025

Support for GamSR

Procurement of devices for both eCRVS and eID for use at registration centers

ID4D Diagnostic of Identity Management System

Technical Assistance - Ongoing

Supporting CRVS bill which is expected to be enacted in 2025

Financial support for Cloud hosting on AWS

Lending Operation - WARDIP -Ongoing

OVERVIEW: IMPROVED BIRTH REGISTRATION



Republic of The Gambia
Birth Certificate



Certificate Number _____
ID Number _____
Surname _____
Given Name(s) _____
Date of Birth _____
Sex _____
Father's Name _____
Father's Nationality _____
Mother's Name _____
Place of Registration _____
Date of Registration _____

I hereby certify the above is a true and correct record from the
Births and Deaths Registry of The Gambia

Signature of Registrar

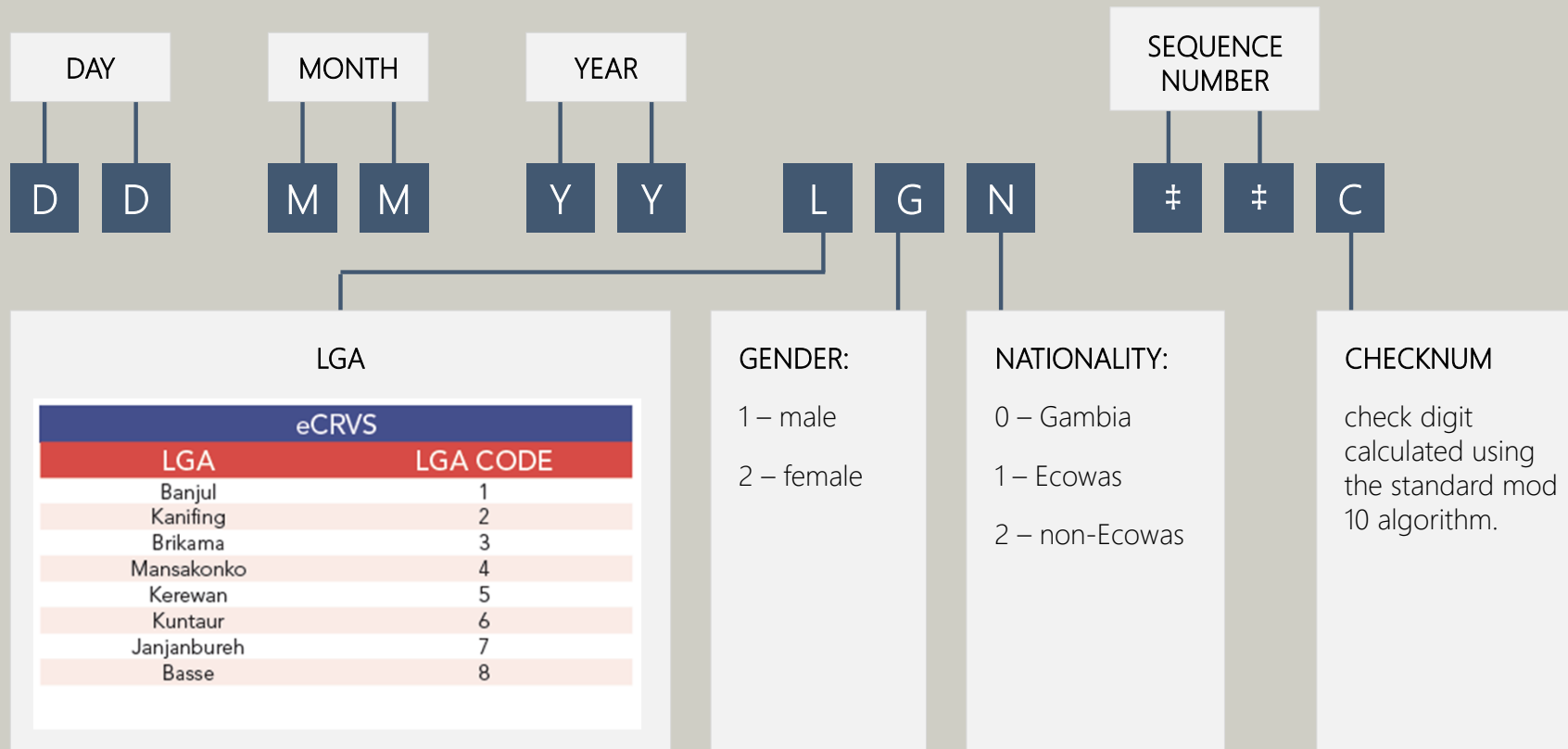


Date Certified

- **Mandate & Ownership of Data:** Ministry of Health
- **Coverage:** 50% -1.2 million registered as per govt
- **Eligibility criteria:** Children born on the Gambian territory and children born to Gambian parents residing outside of the country.
- **Credential issued:** Birth certificate (digitally-enabled via QR code)
- **Cost:** First registration and birth certificate are free. Late registration fees charged and vary by region.
- **Registration Period (Without Penalty):** 30 days from birth, additional 30 in absence of father, additional 30 days in absence of both parents
- **Validity period:** original Birth Certificate valid for life
- **Characteristics of CR system:** Civil registration system is centralized and carried out locally by MOH staff in each district (258 Health facilities and 79 centers) - an online portal for registration is also in works
- **Underlying system:**
 - *eCRVS system* introduced in 2023, Vendor: WCC, Product: HERA
 - Mass enrollment carried out for entire population and electronic records were centralized after data normalization.
 - In case of duplicate or multiple NINs, biometrics of adults in ID database were used to resolve the cases.
 - Structured NIN generated after demographic deduplication.
 - New NIN provided for 0-17yr olds, adults 18+, NIN from ID was populated into eCRVS system to cross verify parents IDs

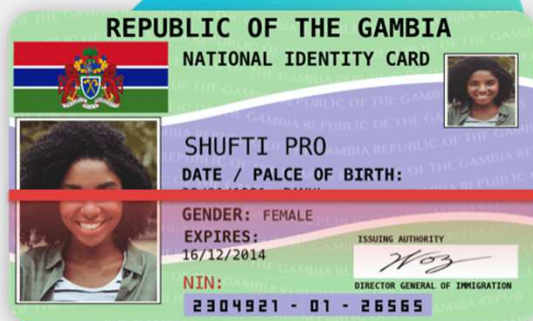
NATIONAL IDENTIFICATION NUMBER

The eCRVS assigns a 12-digit NIN to all citizens and residents, structured as follows:

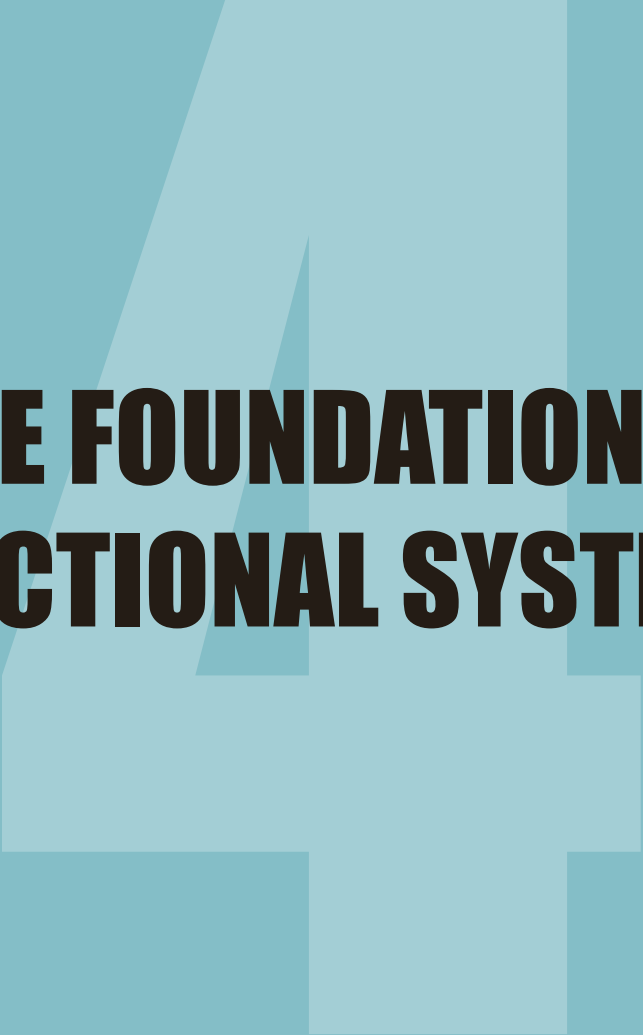


Issues: NIN is not a random number, DoB can easily be extracted from NIN which is a privacy issue and against the best practice

OVERVIEW: NATIONAL ID SYSTEM



- **Mandate:** Ministry of Interior, Department of Immigration
- **Coverage:** Low **63%+ of total population** (MOI to confirm)
- **Eligibility criteria:** Citizens of the Gambia, resident cards issued separately for residents, 18+ years
- **Breeder Documents:** Birth Certificate AND attestation from village chief
- **Credential issued:** National ID Card (contactless polycarbonate smart card) with minimal data
- **Cost:** 450 Dalasi (**~USD 6.63**) – Same cost for first issuance, replacement, renewals for everyone – including vulnerable groups
- **Validity period:** **5 years** – The Act says it should be valid for 10 years
- **Characteristics of Identification system:** Centralized and carried out locally by Dept of Immigration
- **Underlying system:**
 - Previous 5-year PPP contract with Vendor, Semlex expired. Concerns over opaque procurement process.
 - Vendor Proprietary System had been operating new national ID system since 2018 – data rebuilt from scratch
 - Concerns around overseas data storage & privacy now resolved through data localization - vendor left, there was a **crisis of shortage of cards**
 - Structured NIN generated after biometric deduplication which **is a bit different from NIN from eCRVS** (for now). Three digit LGA in eCRVS is district code, while in ID system, its center code.
 - MOU signed (March 2024) to harmonize NIN in both eCRVS and ID system
 - Government advertised new PPP (Built & Transfer) EOI in July 2024



CORE FOUNDATIONAL & FUNCTIONAL SYSTEMS

eCRVS AS FOUNDATIONAL SYSTEM?



PARTIES INVOLVED

MoU b/w Ministry of Health, Ministry of Interior, Ministry of Communications and Digital Economy.



SCOPE

Interoperability of eCRVS and National ID System and use of the same NIN from birth to death.



ACHIEVEMENTS

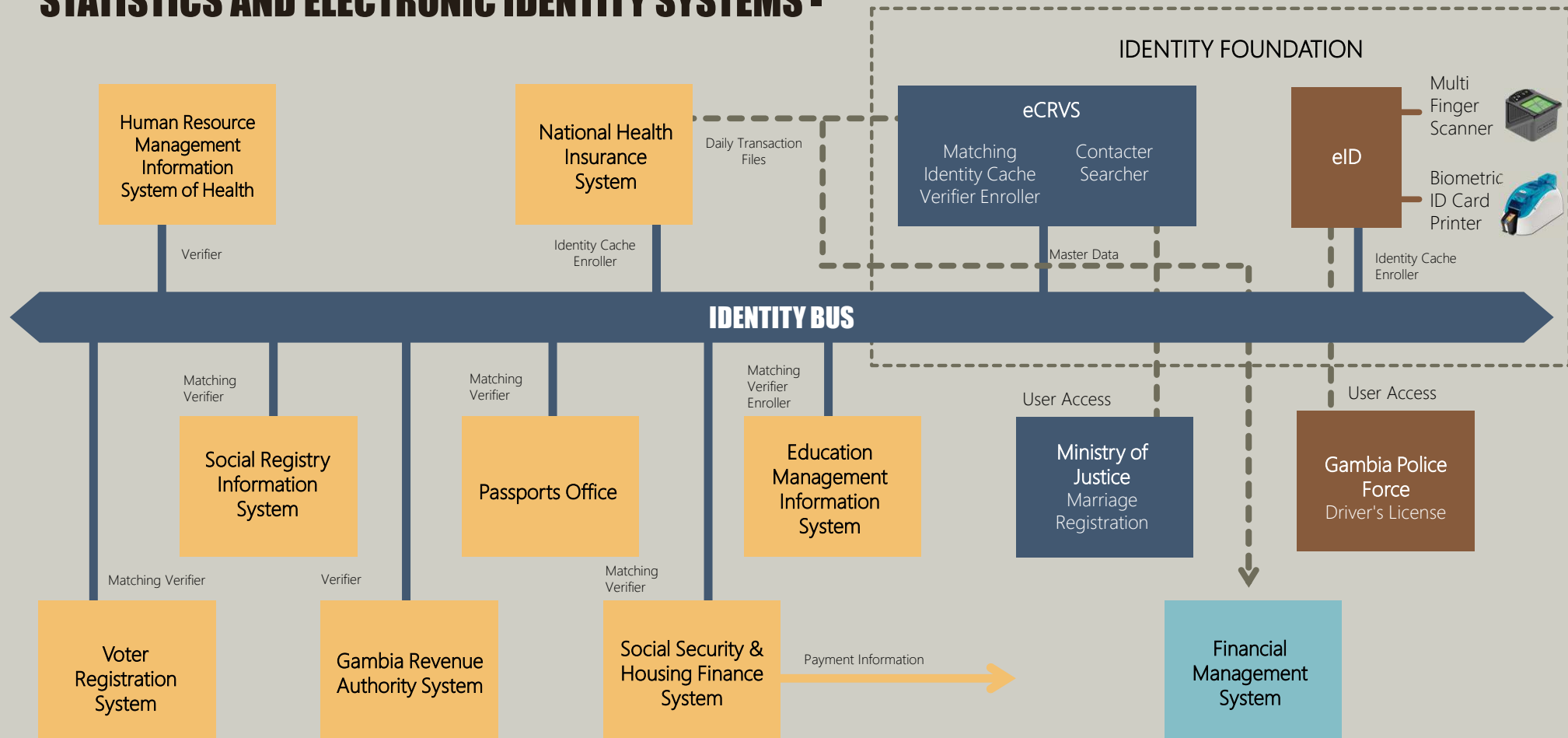
Birth module in operation, Marriage module developed. The system produces Health insurance Cards and claims to be linked with various repositories in future.



CHALLENGES

- New NINs would be generated for all existing records once eCRVS and National ID system are interconnected which could be problematic as one person may end up with two NINs
- NIN is printed on ID card. This will complicate identity verification and authentication if there is a different NIN on the physical card vs. system.
- Feedback mechanism is needed to communicate with eCRVS system, in the event when duplicate is found after deduplication
- Mechanism needed to retire duplicate NINs from all systems

PROPOSED INTEGRATION OF THE GAMBIA ELECTRONIC CIVIL REGISTRATION AND VITAL STATISTICS AND ELECTRONIC IDENTITY SYSTEMS -



DIAGNOSTIC OF CORE FUNCTIONAL SYSTEMS LINKED WITH FOUNDATIONAL ID

DRIVERS LICENSE SYSTEM

- **Purpose:** Issues driving permits, verifies identity for road safety enforcement, and ensures compliance with traffic regulations.
- **Link to Foundational ID:** Uses the National ID system for biometric verification of applicants to prevent identity fraud and duplication.
- **Challenges:** High Cost (850 Dalasi = \$11.81);
Validity of one year only

PASSPORT SYSTEM

- **Purpose:** Issues travel documents, verifies citizenship, and facilitates international mobility. It has its own ABIS
- **Link to Foundational ID:** Uses the National ID number (NIN) and background checks to ensure that passports are issued only to legitimate citizens.
- **Challenges:** Manual Passports still around, Duplicate Passports around – no biometric deduplication with National ID database

HEALTH MANAGEMENT INFORMATION SYSTEM

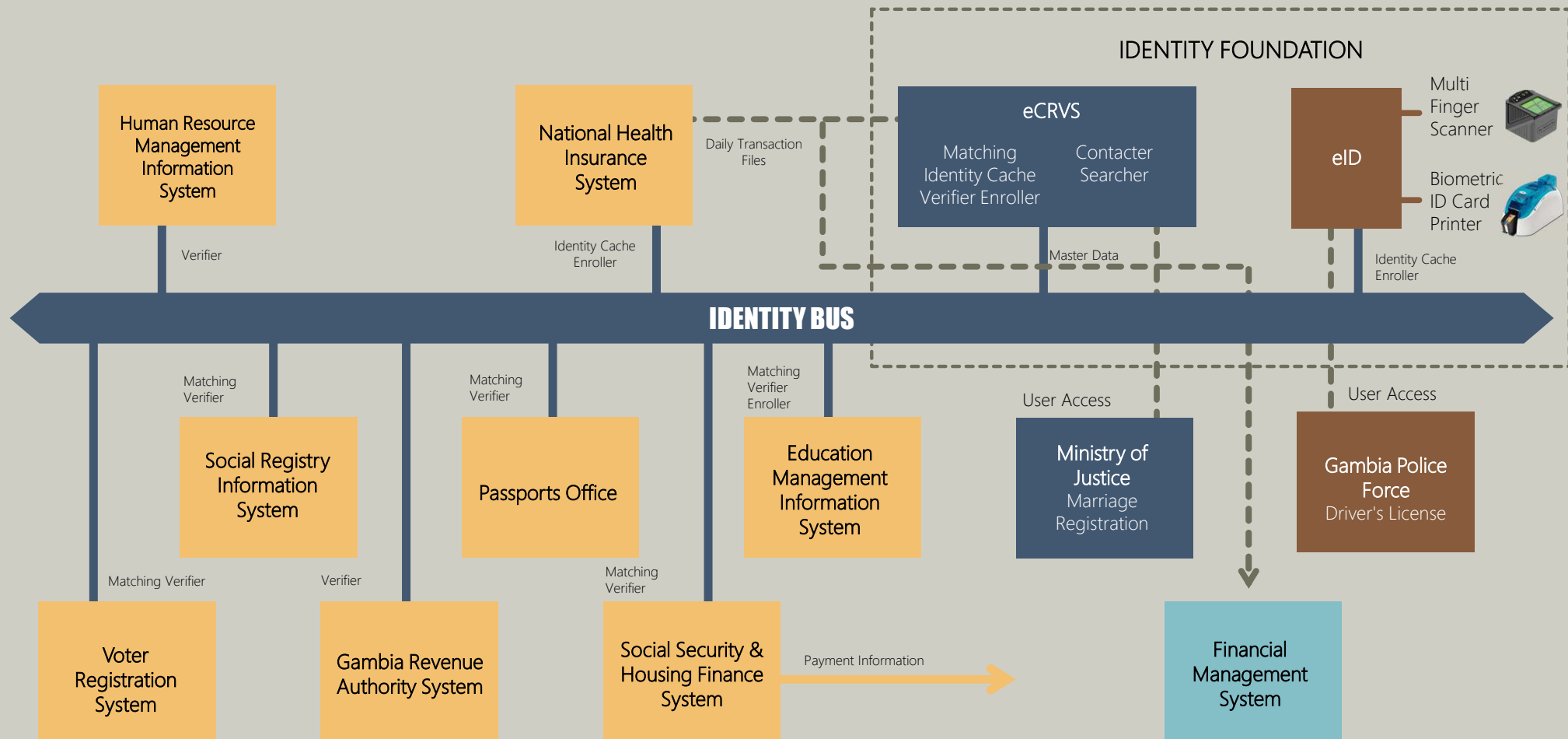
- **Purpose:** Manages patient records, facilitates electronic health services, and supports national health policies, issue Health Cards.. World Bank supported project.
- **Link to Foundational ID:** Uses the eCRVS for unique patient identification for birth certificate, NIN and issues free Health insurance cards, reducing duplicate records, improving service delivery, and ensuring efficient health data management.

Despite few administrative challenges, these integrations help streamline identity verification, enhance service delivery, and reduce fraud, making government services more efficient and accessible – to some extent.

COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS eCRVS AND NATIONAL ID SYSTEM

ID PRINCIPLES	eCRVS	NATIONAL ID SYSTEM
Inclusion & Barriers	• Low Coverage (50%+) –includes adults • Free within prescribed timelines and more affordable	• Low coverage (63% +) • Higher cost esp. for vulnerable groups
Assurance of Uniqueness Trusted and Accuracy Responsive Platform	• Demographic deduplication less robust (low assurance level), • Duplicate NIN issue to be resolved • eCRVS is linked with National ID, is interoperable	• Biometric deduplication more robust (Higher assurance level) • Issues with NIN numbering scheme and duplicate NINs in case of lost/replacement card (with new number) • National ID needs to retire NINs of death records
Open Standards & Vendor Lock-in	• Proprietary S/W with perpetual license • Govt taking over contract of eCRVS	• Proprietary Software with perpetual license • Vendor Lock-in issues
Verification of identity attributes	• Establishment of legal identity • Adequate identity proofing as document of parents are cross-checked but could be further strengthened	• Birth certificate is a breeder document • Slightly stronger assurance as records can be flagged as duplicates post biometric deduplication
Safeguards (Data protection, privacy and security)	• NIN printed on birth certificates which accentuates privacy & security concerns • Local data storage in line with privacy best practices • Data Protection and Privacy Policy in 2020, bill pending approval so not operationalized – weak sector legislation	• NIN printed on card includes DoB in numbering scheme- a privacy concern • Data storage is now localized privacy best practices • Data Protection and Privacy Policy in 2020, bill pending approval so not operationalized – weak sector legislation
Governance	• Fragmented mandate, independent oversight needed	• Independent oversight needed

INTEGRATION OF THE GAMBIA eCRVS AND eIDENTITY SYSTEMS UNDER WAY





SECTORAL SYSTEMS & RELATIONSHIP WITH ID SYSTEMS

SECTORAL SYSTEMS AND RELATIONSHIP WITH ID

GamSIR

Gambia Social Registry

Data on individuals and households eligible for social protection programs.

CHALLENGES: lack of efficiency, high cost of reentering data already available, lost opportunity to link it with foundational ID

PCU-GIRAV

Gambia Inclusive and Resilient Agricultural Value Chain Development

Registers farmers for agricultural development and support programs

CHALLENGES: Exclusions (farmers with no ID, Birth Certs, Passport or DL), duplicates, no common identifier, inconsistent registration process

eMIS

Education Management Information System

Manages education sector data for policy planning and monitoring

CHALLENGES: lack of common identifier, scholarship mis-allocation, duplicate entries, inconsistent naming conventions, exam registration, data integration with other repositories and resource allocation problems (text books, teachers, funding etc.)

TIN

Tax Identification Number (TIN) System

Registers and tracks taxpayers for efficient tax administration

CHALLENGES: Inconsistent data entry practices and lack of standardized formats, fragmented system due to absence of ID system, data quality issues, duplication, limited interoperability with civil registries

SECTORAL SYSTEMS AND RELATIONSHIP WITH ID (Contin.)

Planned

CKYC

Centralized Know Your Customer (CKYC) System

Intends to store KYC data of bank account holders to streamline verification & reduce duplication

CHALLENGES: frustration due to lack of electronic ID authentication system, KYC & AML compliance issues, lack of biometric ID & passports, reliance of paper-based IDs

Voters List

Voter Registration Database by IEC

Registers and maintains biometric voter data for elections

CHALLENGE: Exclusions –ID Coverage

Planned

PURA's SIM DB

Intends to maintain records of all registered SIM cards to enhance security, combat fraud, and ensure compliance with telecom regulations

CHALLENGES: No electronic ID authentication, no way to validate a mobile number, duplication, fraud

SSHFC

Social Security & Housing Finance Repository

Manages 4 funds: Federated Pension Fund, Housing Finance Fund, Industrial Injuries Compensation Fund and National Provident Fund

CHALLENGE: It has its own unique 7 -digit identifier, duplication, no integration with National ID

SECTORAL SYSTEMS AND RELATIONSHIP WITH ID (Contin.)

Planned

Payroll System

The Gambia Public Procurement & Payment Management System

Its HR/Payroll module (API) is being designed for integration with the National ID to automate govt payroll ensuring accuracy, transparency, and efficiency in management of public funds

CHALLENGES: frustration due to lack of electronic ID authentication system, recording proof of life of active workers, reliance on alternate IDs such as TIN, and data inaccurate master data (self-reported data)



SUMMARY OF FINDINGS & RECOMMENDATIONS

Challenges/Findings & Recommendations -ID4D Principle: INCLUSION

Challenge/ Finding	Recommendation
Barriers in documentation requirements: Needing parents' birth certificates excludes many applicants, especially where parents are deceased or records inaccessible.	Revise documentation policies – remove or relax parental birth certificate requirements. Introduce alternative verification (community attestations, affidavits, digital registry lookups).
High ID card fees (450 Dalasi) limit access: Vulnerable groups, including civil servants, struggle to self-finance IDs, leading to inequities in access to services and low HRMIS coverage.	Introduce fee waivers, subsidies, or government/donor financing. Conduct financial analysis and re-evaluate fee structures for affordability.
Discrimination in birth registration: Children born to non-Gambian parents in Gambian facilities sometimes denied certificates. Confusion between birth registration and naturalization creates exclusion risks. Children born abroad to Gambian parent's face difficulties in securing recognition.	Clarify and harmonize legal framework to separate birth registration from nationality. Guarantee birth certificates for all children born in Gambian facilities regardless of parents' nationality. Improve recognition procedures for children born abroad.
Geographic access barriers: Registration centers limited, forcing long travel distances.	Expand registration points (stationary & mobile) by leveraging 258 health facilities and 79 registration centers. Explore co-location of CRVS & ID services. Partner with community leaders to streamline the application process and reduce number of trips.
Marginalized groups at risk of exclusion: Women, rural poor, refugees, and informal workers face systemic barriers.	Run targeted enrollment campaigns for underserved groups. Partner with CSOs for outreach. Enable inclusive participatory feedback loops in registration design and implementation.

Challenges/Findings & Recommendations -ID4D Principle: DESIGN

Challenge/ Finding	Recommendation
Lack of foundational ID authentication with functional systems: National ID, CRVS, and sectoral systems (TIN, EMIS, HMIS, social protection) operate in silos, hindering interoperability and fraud prevention.	Build interoperability frameworks/APIs to connect foundational and functional IDs. Introduce eKYC, ABIS verification, and real-time CRVS linkages for liveness/death record checks.
Absence of a full digital ID ecosystem: Despite ABIS investment, there is no fully operational digital authentication mechanism. Functional systems rely on fragmented alternatives.	Establish a complete digital ID ecosystem with unique, permanent NINs. Mandate biometric deduplication and liveness detection.
Uniqueness concerns: Risk of duplicate or multiple NINs (new numbers issued when cards lost/stolen).	Reform NIN issuance to ensure immutability of ID numbers. Introduce deduplication audits and independent oversight.
Seemingly high procurement costs / vendor lock-in risks: Current BOT model repeats past mistakes; smartcard procurement costs are high.	Re-evaluate BOT model and procurement strategy. Explore open standards, competitive tenders, and alternative cheaper credential options with adequate security. Enable local/regional card production to cut costs.
Unclear data hosting policy: Citizen data storage (offshore vs. in-country) is unresolved.	Optimize data hosting using national facilities. Define clear data retention and hosting policies for sovereignty and trust.
Weak integration with HRMIS & payment systems: HRMIS relies on NID despite low coverage and fragility. ITAS depends on the delayed National Payment Gateway.	Accelerate implementation of the National Payment Gateway with clear timelines. Ensure synchronization between HRMIS, ITAS, and payment gateway rollout.
Capacity constraints: Birth & Death Registry, MOCDE, GICTA, NHIA, MoH IT units suffer from staff shortages and inadequate skills.	Workforce planning and tailored training. Expand staffing in registry & IT units. Align local capacity-building with sustainability and reduce over-reliance on vendors.

Challenges/Findings & Recommendations -ID4D Principle: GOVERNANCE

Challenge/ Finding	Recommendation
Unclear institutional leadership & fragmented governance: While GICTA is expected to play a role, no single agency leads the Digital ID & eCRVS agenda, causing overlaps and gaps.	Establish a governance charter defining roles: MoCDE/GICTA (interoperability, APIs, eKYC); Interior (National ID); MoH (CRVS integration); MoJ (legal reforms, Marriages, Adoption)); Central Bank (CKYC/eKYC); PURA (SIM, APIs); IEC (voter registry). Define KPIs and reporting cadence.
Over-reliance on vendors & weak sustainability: Advanced vendor technologies create dependency. SLAs not clearly defined; lack of local ownership.	Embed strong SLAs in vendor contracts. Conduct system audits (performance, security, privacy). Foster local technical expertise and reduce vendor reliance through capacity transfer. Past investment on eCRVS should not be disbanded.
Data protection & privacy gaps: Data Protection and Privacy Bill (2020) still pending approval, leaving no enforceable safeguards. Risks of misuse undermine trust.	Expedite passage and implementation of the Data Protection Bil, and Data Protection Unit. Establish independent Data Protection Authority. Introduce sectoral supervision (SIM registration, CKYC).
Weak cyber resilience: No unified cybersecurity oversight for ID/CRVS.	Establish CSIRT/SOC functions and minimum-security standards for ID/CRVS. Align Cybercrime Law, National Cybersecurity Strategy, and Communications Bill.
Poor communication & citizen trust: Lack of open, participatory platforms undermines transparency and inclusivity.	Institutionalize continuous feedback mechanisms with CSOs and communities. Enhance public awareness on data protection, privacy rights, and service access

RECOMMENDATIONS - GICTA TO PLAY CENTRAL ROLE TO:



ENSURE SUSTAINABLE TECH CAPACITY & SUPPORT

- Strengthen local IT capacity to manage vendor-specific technologies.
- Establish long-term support agreements with clear SLAs for system maintenance.
- Invest in continuous training for government staff to reduce vendor dependency.



IMPROVE PROCUREMENT TRANSPARENCY & GOVERNANCE

- Enhance transparency in tender processes to avoid risks of corruption by formulating regulations to institutionalize centralized technical procurement and local development.
- Conduct independent due diligence on selected vendors to mitigate reputational & performance risks.



HARMONIZE DIGITAL ID & eCRVS IMPLEMENTATION

- Avoid overlapping systems by aligning the Digital ID and eCRVS solutions to maximize impact.
- Develop an integration roadmap to link CRVS with Digital ID and functional systems.



ENSURE COST-EFFECTIVENESS & SUSTAINABILITY

- Reevaluate the PPP- BOT cost, ensuring value for money in alignment with population needs.



MAXIMIZE INTEROPERABILITY OF FUNCTIONAL REPOSITORIES

- Link foundational ID (Digital ID) with functional repositories (Tax, Social Protection, EMIS, HMIS, CKYC, SIM Registration).
- Use ABIS for biometric verification across government agencies to reduce fraud & inefficiencies.
- Develop a unified eKYC framework to streamline identity verification in financial & telecom sectors.



ESTABLISH ELECTRONIC IDENTITY AUTHENTICATION

- Introduce eID authentication mechanisms to reduce reliance on manual identity verification.
- Enable secure digital credentials that can be used across different services (social protection, healthcare, finance).

Embedding The Gambia's DPI within National and Regional Strategies

Key National Strategies & Plans

The Gambia National Development Plan (NDP) 2023-2027

Alignment:

- **Pillar 1: Governance for Accountability, Social Cohesion, and National Reconciliation:** A robust digital ID system is foundational for improving public administration, enhancing transparency in service delivery, and securing citizen rights. It directly supports goals related to "**modernizing the civil service**" and "**strengthening civic engagement**."
- **Pillar 4: Transforming the Economy for Inclusive Growth:** Digital ID is a key driver of financial inclusion (e.g., enabling secure bank account opening), digital economy development, and improving the business environment through trusted identity verification.

Link: Position the DPI as the "**foundational digital infrastructure**" required to achieve the NDP's cross-cutting goals of good governance and economic transformation. It is not just an ID card, but a tool for implementing the entire NDP.

The Gambia Digital Economy Strategy (2021-2026)

Alignment: This strategy explicitly identifies "**Digital Identity**" as a core foundational pillar. It is a prerequisite for other pillars like digital payments, e-government services, and digital literacy.

Link: Digital Economy Strategy should be the primary policy mandate for the DPI project. The recommendations in ID4D diagnostic should be framed as the *implementation roadmap* for achieving this specific strategic objective.

Embedding The Gambia's ID4D Diagnostic within National and Regional Strategies

Key Regional (ECOWAS) Strategies & Plans

ECOWAS National Biometric Identity Card (ENBIC)

Alignment: The Gambia, as an ECOWAS member state, is a signatory to the protocol adopting a common regional biometric identity card for citizen mobility and integration.

Link: The Gambia's National ID must be framed as the **national implementation of this regional obligation**. This elevates the project from a national priority to a regional commitment, adding a layer of diplomatic importance and potential for accessing regional funding and technical support.

ECOWAS Digital Transformation Agenda

Alignment: This regional agenda promotes a single digital market and cross-border digital services, all of which require interoperable and trusted digital identity systems.

Link: The Gambia's DPI can be positioned as being "**ECOWAS-ready**"—built to eventually interoperate with other member states' systems to enable seamless regional digital trade and mobility, thus positioning The Gambia as a regional leader in digital integration.

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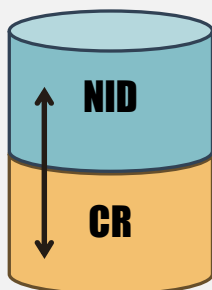
CASE STUDIES OF OTHER COUNTRIES

DIFFERENT CIVIL REGISTRATION & NATIONAL ID MODELS

FULLY-INTEGRATED (one system)

- BR is enrollment for ID/PR; card issued at appropriate age
- One responsible agency
- ID number issued at birth

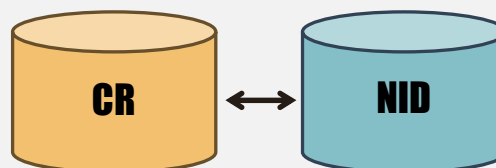
Examples: Thailand, South Africa, Uganda



LINKED

- Data exchanged/verified between databases/registries, often electronically and automatically
- One or two responsible agencies

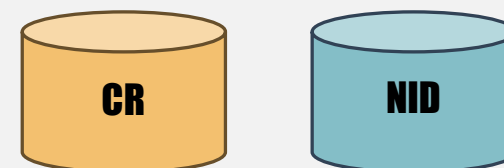
Examples: Indonesia, Tanzania, India (sort of), Pakistan



FRAGMENTED

- No data exchange
- Depends on individuals bringing physical documents for verification
- Separate agencies

Examples: Nigeria, Bangladesh, Ghana, Gambia

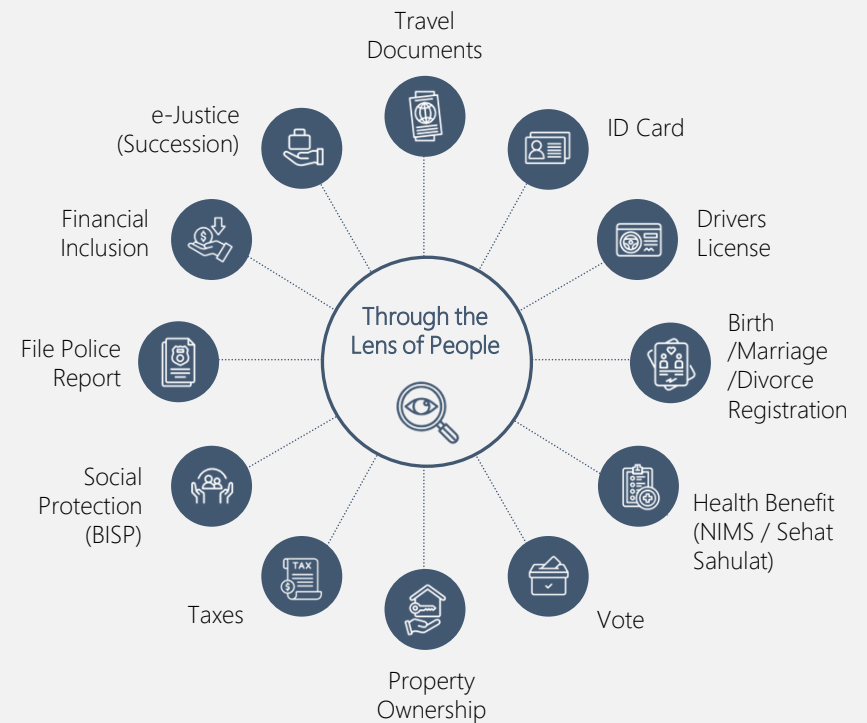
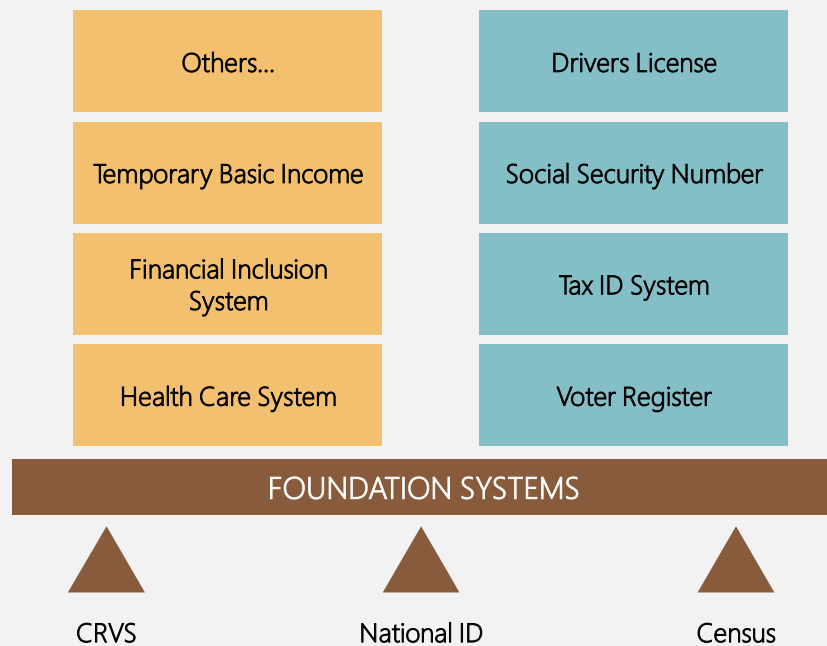


CASE STUDY: PAKISTAN

PEOPLE CENTRIC DIGITAL GOVERNANCE INTERVENTIONS



FUNCTIONAL SYSTEMS [Digital Public Goods]

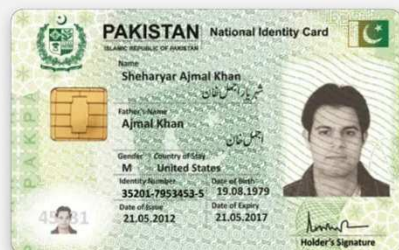


CASE STUDY: PAKISTAN LINKING FOUNDATIONAL & FUNCTIONAL ID FOR BETTER GOVERNANCE OUTCOMES



**145 M
ISSUED**

- 98% Adult citizens registered



BIOMETRIC
POS



MOBILE
PHONES



- 801 NADRA OFFICES
- 17000+ FRANCHISES
- 250 MRVs
- 60 MANPACK UNITS

Social Protection -Benazir Income Support Program

- 227 Billion PKR distributed to 9.4 Million Women since 2010

Electoral Rolls

- 37 million invalid entries in 80 million voters list found when compared
- Transparent voters list reduced trust deficit

Disaster Management

- 82 billion PKR distributed to 2.9 million families during worst floods of 2010

Health Programs

- Health Insurance Program on smart card
- 10 million families enrolled

Tax Reforms

- Using Bigdata Analytics discovered 3.5 million rich tax evaders

Anti-Corruption

- Reduced Human Trafficking
- eKYC to combat money laundering
- Enhancing capacity of financial crime probes

CASE STUDY: MALAWI

REALISING A WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT STRATEGY FOR LEGAL DIGITAL ID



**10 M
ISSUED**

- 99% Adult citizens registered
- Women register more than men



BIOMETRIC
POS



MOBILE
PHONES



- 28 DISTRICT OFFICES
- 100+ POST OFFICES
- 2000 BIOMETRIC REGISTRATION KITS

Electoral Rolls

- 6.8 million registered by scanning ID, recording savings in cost of operation
- Turnout increased by 4%

Payroll System

- 4,024 ghost workers removed, saving MKW 388 million per month

Pandemic Management

- Just launched e-Payment system for COVID-19 affected people
- Contact-tracing app

Health Programs

- eVIN for medicine tracking and distribution in works
- e-Health Applet on chip

Farmers Subsidy

- Farmers Subsidy Management Input Program linked with ID

Anti-Corruption

- Ghost workers removed
- eKYC to combat money laundering
- Enhancing capacity of financial crime probes

CASE STUDIES: INDIA & SINGAPORE FROM SILOS TO PLATFORMS. ID AS A PUBLIC SERVICE



Minimal collection of personal data → exchange via interoperability platforms ("once only principle")

Open standards / APIs → avoid lock-in and facilitate innovation with new applications and modes of service delivery

ID as a fundamental component of national digital transformation strategies





NEXT STEPS

NEXT STEPS

POLICY & GOVERNANCE ALIGNMENT

- **Finalize a National Digital ID & CRVS Strategy** – Align with national priorities, ensuring interoperability between foundational & functional IDs.
- **Review Legal & Regulatory Frameworks** – Assess and update laws governing data protection, digital identity, eCRVS, and functional repositories.
- **Clarify Data Sovereignty** – Confirm if citizen data is stored in-country or offshore and establish clear data protection protocols.

INSTITUTIONAL COORDINATION & CAPACITY BUILDING

- **Establish a Multi-Stakeholder Task Force** – Include MoCDE, GICTA, Ministry of Interior, IEC, Central Bank, Social Protection, and Telcos to coordinate Digital ID & CRVS efforts.
- **Invest in Local IT Capacity** – Reduce vendor reliance by training government IT teams on managing Digital ID, eCRVS & ABIS systems.
- **Develop SLAs for System Support** – Ensure long-term vendor support post-implementation, with knowledge transfer to local teams.

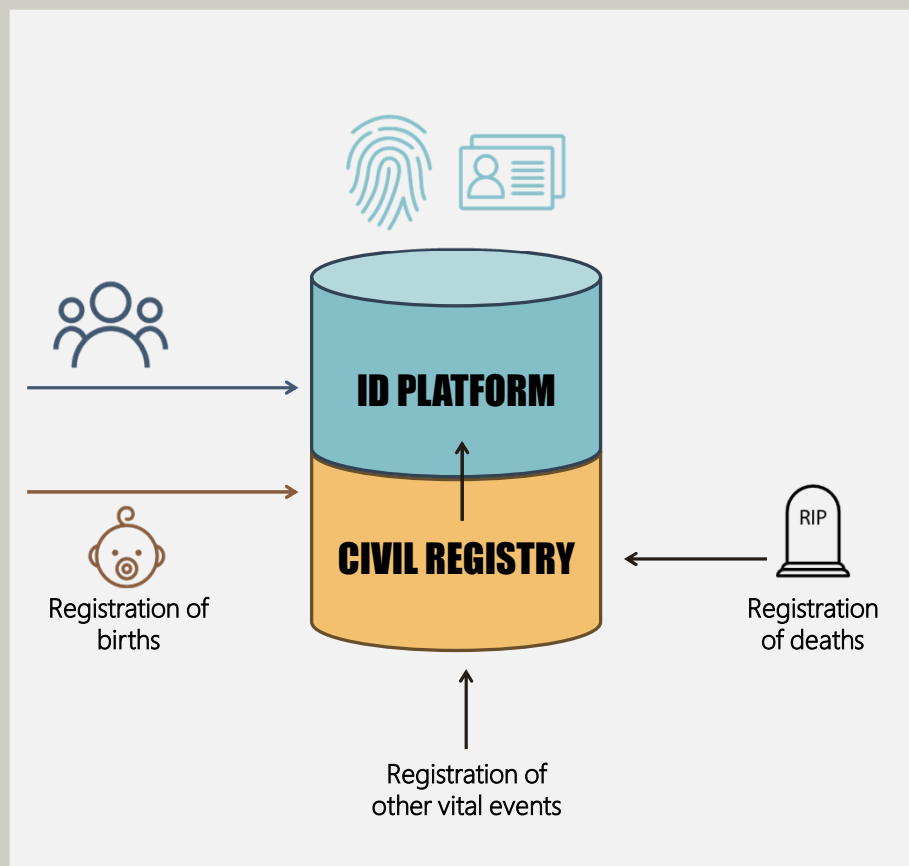
STOCK AND FLOW APPROACH TO REGISTRATION

THE STOCK (People alive today)

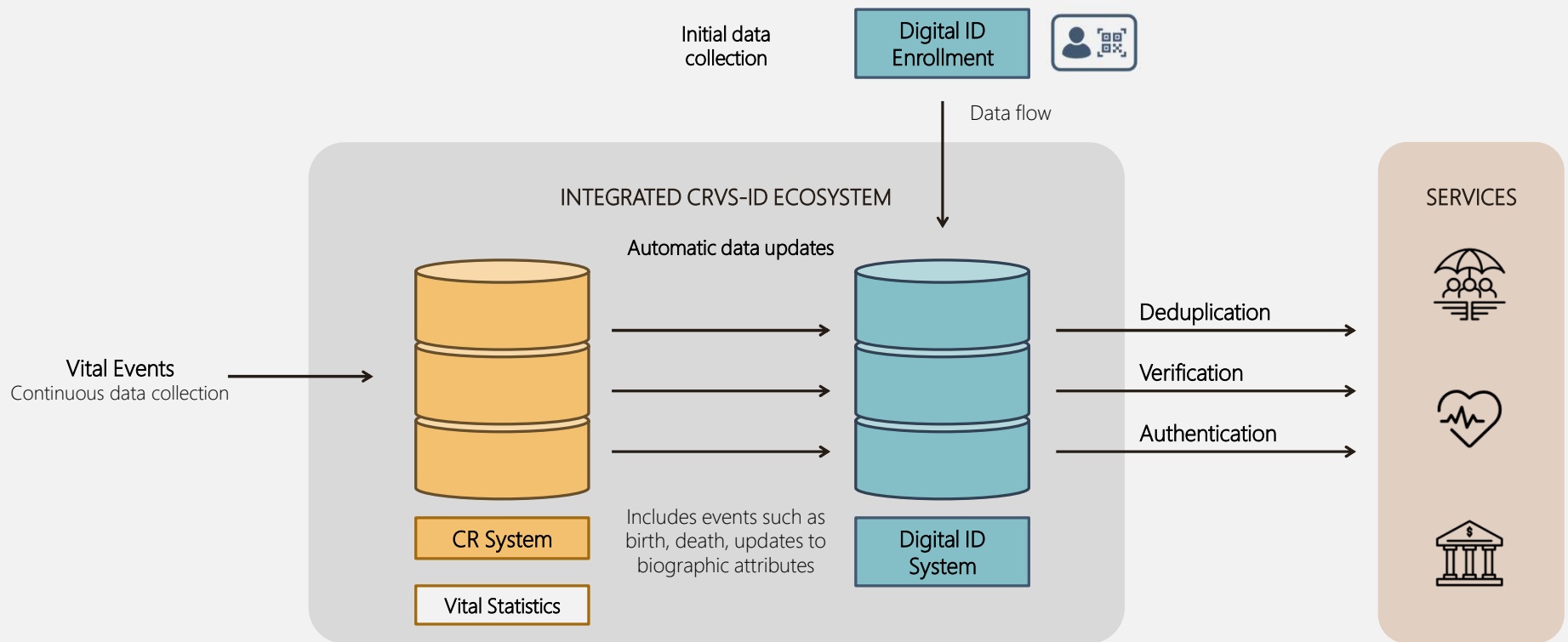
- Foundational/National ID provided after registration with birth certificate / record as evidence, if they have one.
- Alternative evidence (or witnesses) accepted to prevent exclusion.
- No need to register birth retroactively, but this service is made available.

THE FLOW (Children today and born from tomorrow)

- Unique ID number provided through birth registration
- Biometrics collected at appropriate age, if necessary.

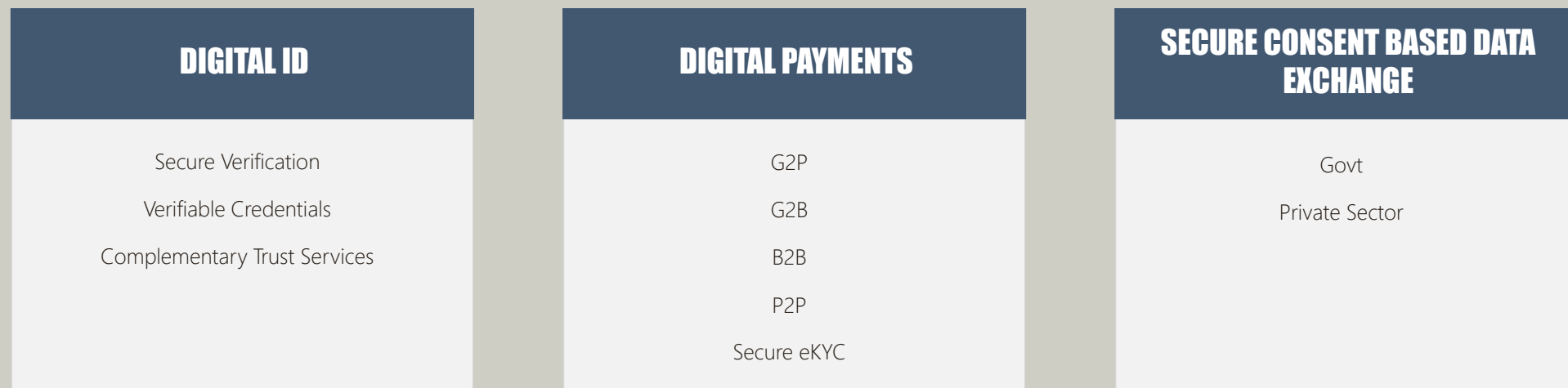


INTEGRATED CRVS-ID ECOSYSTEM



GICTA can develop an API for Identity Authentication

MOVING TOWARDS DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE



PHYSICAL DOCUMENTS

Present identity information non-digitally

DIGITAL CREDENTIALS

Attest to a person's identity in a digital environment (i.e., used for digital authentication)

ADDITIONAL FACTORS

Confirm a person is associated with a digital credential

A robust Digital ID is vital for next-generation AI-powered services — without it, use cases like proactive, personalized outreach risk missing transformative AI-driven benefits

Diagnostic Meetings/workshops (2025)

Multi-stakeholder workshops	Technical meetings with key stakeholders			Site visits
Kick-off meeting	MOI (Interior), Dept. of Immigration	MOH (Health)	MPA (Public Administration)	Visited registration centers, urban and rural, National ID and CRVS, Central Bank, MOCDE & GICTA
Internal Peer Review	Ministry of Gender, Children & Social Affairs	MOBSE (Basic and Sec. Education)	MNOs & GAMTEL	
Validation following drafting of finding & recommendations	Ministry of Law & Justice	MOGDE & GICTA	Central Bank	
Workshop/knowledge exchange with sector relying parties	Development Partners (IOM)	NGOs/CSOs	MOJ	Legal Assessment
				Ongoing- Preliminary report with finding is completed
+ others, Banks, MNOs, Development Partners, NGOs/CSOs				

